

What is a planet?

A planet is a ball-shaped object that orbits (travels around) a star. Eight planets orbit the star we call the Sun. The four planets nearest to the Sun are small and rocky. The four outer planets are larger and made mostly of gas. Together, the Sun and the eight planets make up the solar system.

The Sun

The Sun is a star at the center of the solar system. Every planet orbits (travels around) it.

Giant Jupiter

Jupiter is the biggest planet—larger than the other seven planets put together.

Mini Mercury

Mercury is the smallest planet and the closest one to the Sun.

Life on Earth

Earth is where we live. It is the only planet in the solar system known to have life.

Spinning backward :

Venus is slightly smaller than Earth. It spins in the opposite direction from most of the other planets.

...The red planet

Mars is known as the red planet. Its color comes from the iron minerals in the soil on its surface.

Quick quiz



Is Venus bigger or smaller than Earth?



Why does Mars look red?



How strong are the winds on Neptune?

A day on Jupiter is

